

Alex Rivera

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Senior Software Engineer · Platform & Infrastructure

SUMMARY

Platform engineer with 9 years of experience building and operating distributed systems at scale. Focused on developer productivity, reliability engineering, and the intersection of infrastructure and product.

Passionate about open-source tooling and mentoring engineers transitioning into platform roles.

EXPERIENCE

Staff Platform Engineer

2021 – Present

Veritas Systems · San Francisco, CA

- Designed and led migration of 120 microservices from EC2 to Kubernetes, reducing infra costs by 38% and improving deployment frequency from weekly to on-demand.
- Built an internal developer platform (IDP) adopted by 6 product teams; cut new-service onboarding from 3 days to under 2 hours.
- Established SLO framework and error-budget policies; p99 latency for critical paths dropped from 340ms to 90ms over 18 months.
- Grew and led a team of 5 platform engineers across two time zones.

Go · Kubernetes · Terraform · AWS · Datadog

Senior Software Engineer

2018 – 2021

Meridian Health · Remote

- Re-architected the claims processing pipeline to event-driven (Kafka), enabling real-time fraud detection and reducing processing lag from 4 hours to under 3 minutes.
- Led HIPAA compliance initiative across 14 backend services; zero findings in two consecutive external audits.
- Mentored 4 junior engineers; 3 were promoted within 18 months.

Java · Kafka · PostgreSQL · GCP

Software Engineer

2015 – 2018

Loopline Technologies · Austin, TX

- Built core billing infrastructure processing \$2M+ monthly recurring revenue.
- Introduced contract testing (Pact) across 8 services, reducing integration failures in production by 60%.

Python · Django · Stripe · Redis · PostgreSQL

AWARDS

Platform Engineering Excellence Award

Veritas Systems · 2023

Awarded for the IDP project, recognised as the highest-impact internal tooling initiative of the year.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

Go · Python · TypeScript · Java · Bash

INFRASTRUCTURE

Kubernetes · Terraform · AWS · GCP · Helm

DATA & MESSAGING

PostgreSQL · Redis · Kafka · Elasticsearch

OBSERVABILITY

Datadog · Prometheus · Grafana · OpenTelemetry

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin

2011 – 2015

BSc · Computer Science

Graduated with honours. Teaching assistant for Distributed Systems (CS378) for two semesters.

LANGUAGES

English Native · Spanish Professional working proficiency

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

CNCF · 2023

AWS Solutions Architect – Professional

Amazon Web Services · 2022

Google Professional Cloud Architect

Google Cloud · 2020 · exp.

SIDE PROJECTS & INTERESTS

driftwatch open source

CLI tool for detecting infrastructure drift between Terraform state and live cloud resources. 600+ GitHub stars.

Go · AWS · Terraform

k8s-cost-exporter open source

Prometheus exporter that surfaces per-namespace and per-deployment cost estimates from cloud billing APIs.

Go · Kubernetes · Prometheus